

SK1127 Conflict and Conflict Resolution

Seminar 2: Conflict resolution

In this seminar, you will engage in a negotiation simulation aimed at resolving a conflict between two fictional states, Zamora and Kivala, located in a fictional Africa. Through negotiations facilitated by mediators, you will work toward reaching a mutually acceptable ceasefire agreement while also seeking to secure your core interests. The simulation connects to course themes on conflict and conflict resolution, while providing an opportunity to try your hands at negotiation.

Readings

- Fisher, R., Ury, W. L., & Patton, B. (2011). *Getting to yes: Negotiating agreement without giving in*. Penguin. Read summary available [here](#).
- Revisit course literature from lectures 6 and 7.

SIMULATION: ZAMORA AND KIVALA

Background

The year is 2026, and tensions are escalating between two neighboring African states, Zamora and Kivala. **Zamora** is a resource-rich country in Africa with a population of 34 million people. Despite its vast natural wealth, Zamora has suffered from chronic political instability and widespread corruption, leaving its population with a per capita income of just \$550. The country has been under the authoritarian rule of General Obade (aka “The People’s Hammer” or “Papa Obade”) who seized power in a coup six years ago. Known for his opulent lifestyle and iron-fisted control, General Obade’s regime has been internationally condemned for its human rights abuses and repression of political opposition.

Neighboring **Kivala** is a landlocked nation with a population of 19 million. Despite its limited natural resources, Kivala has enjoyed relative political stability under President Emmanuel Seko, a medical doctor and long-standing leader respected for his advocacy of regional cooperation and sustainable development. However, beneath his outward moderation, Dr. Seko is keen on expanding Kivala’s influence, particularly by gaining access to Zamora’s untapped mineral reserves, which are crucial for Kivala’s economic growth.

The Conflict

The conflict erupted ten days ago when armed militants, allegedly backed by Kivala, attacked a military outpost in Rengo, a critical border town and the hometown of General Obade. The assault killed several Zamoran soldiers. In retaliation, Zamora launched a

cross-border strike into Kivala, targeting a rebel camp operated by the Zamoran Democratic Front (ZDF)—an insurgent group aiming to overthrow Obade’s regime—and which allegedly operates out of Kivalan territory. The retaliation resulted in over 250 casualties, significantly raising tensions between the two countries.

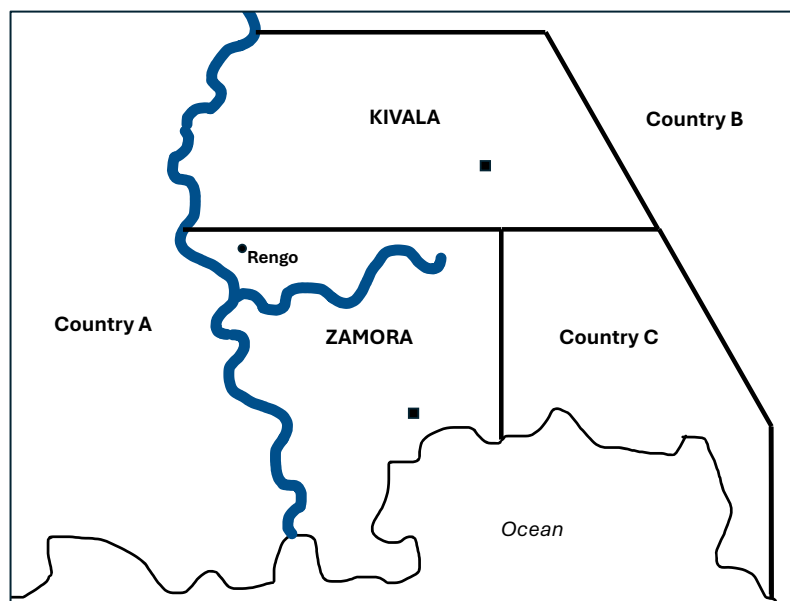
Kivala immediately filed a formal complaint with the African Union (AU), accusing Zamora of breaching its sovereignty and warning of severe repercussions unless Zamoran forces withdrew and issued a public apology. Although Zamora eventually pulled back its troops, the situation remained highly volatile.

Five days ago, the conflict took a dangerous turn when rebel ZDF forces, with direct support from Kivalan troops, launched a coordinated invasion into northern Zamora, advancing towards Rengo with the objective of capturing the town and eventually pushing on to seize the capital and depose General Obade. In response, Zamora urgently appealed to the AU, accusing Kivala of blatant aggression and demanding immediate intervention to halt the invasion and enforce the withdrawal of Kivalan forces.

Current Situation

The AU has intervened, calling for a ceasefire and offering to mediate a peaceful resolution. The AU has invited representatives from both Zamora and Kivala to a neutral venue to discuss the terms of the ceasefire. The stakes are high, as both states are facing intense internal and external pressures. The upcoming negotiations will be critical in determining whether the region can steer clear of further violence and find a path to lasting stability, or if the conflict will spiral into a full-scale war, potentially drawing in other nations and destabilizing the entire region.

Figure 1. Map of Zamora and Kivala



Simulation logistics and timeline

The simulation will take place in 3 designated rooms with separate areas set up for each team (Zamoran, Kivalan, and AU Mediators) to hold private discussions. A central space (the main seminar room) will be used for joint negotiations. The seminar leader will manage the timeline and guide transitions between phases. Please stay within your designated area during the team preparation phase to maintain the flow and confidentiality of the simulation.

1. Introduction (15 minutes): Overview of the scenario and roles.
2. Team Preparation (20 minutes): Private team discussions and strategy development using the work sheet. The mediators draft a first proposal for an agreement.
3. Negotiation Phase (60-90 minutes): Joint negotiation facilitated by the AU mediators (and the seminar leader).
4. Debriefing (20-30 minutes): Group discussion on outcomes, strategies, and key lessons.

Negotiation and mediation using the Single-Text Negotiation method

In this simulation, we will use the Single-Text Negotiation method to keep the process focused and collaborative.

1. Initial draft: Based on their understanding, the mediator team will create a draft of the agreement. This draft will be shared with (or showed to) both sides as the starting point for the discussions. It can be as elegant as you want – a list of bullets on a paper or the board is fine.
2. Negotiation: Both sides will openly discuss the draft agreement together. You can suggest changes, raise concerns, or highlight what you agree with. The mediator will guide the conversation to ensure that both sides are heard. If a team needs to consult internally, it may request to do so. If the mediator team needs to speak to parties separately, it can ask to do so. The mediator team runs the process, under the general guidance of the seminar teacher.
3. Revising and finalizing: The mediator will make changes to the draft based on the discussion.
4. Steps 2-3 continues until both sides agree on the final version of the agreement or we run out of time.

Work sheet: Positions and Interests

Use this sheet to discuss and analyze the situation and devise your negotiation strategy.

	Kivala	Zamora	AU mediators
Positions			
Underlying interests			